Practice workbook · Why people obey - and how to stop blind obedience

Factors (personality and situation) that raise or lower obedience to a person in authority, and ways to stop blind obedience.

6 question parts: 1 worked-example retry and 5 further practice parts.
Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Practise one question type at a time. Attempt the part inside the red boundary; the rest of the question and any figures are kept for context. Write your working in the answer space.

The first question is a retry of the website worked example, without its solution. Check your answers online with 'Check my answer', or ask your teacher for the answer booklet.

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Type ID: PSY-SOC-01

1. Question 21 · part whole · 4 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Worked-example retry · Attempt part whole only.

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21 A football team is in the final match of its season and is trying to win a trophy. The team is not as good as the other team it is playing.

The manager of the football team asks his players to kick and hurt the opposition players during the match. He tells them to shout insults at them and push them over in an effort to win the match.

Explain **two** ways to prevent blind obedience to the football manager.

You must use concepts or research evidence about obedience to justify your answer.

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(Total for Question 21 = 4 marks)

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1. Question 21 · part whole · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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2. Question 24 · part a · 4 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

24 Adam is interested in people's reactions to the influence of authority. He asks male and female participants to come to a room individually.

Half of the male and female participants are asked by a man dressed as a firefighter to lie down on the floor next to the window as there is 'a safety issue in the room'. The other half of the male and female participants are asked by a 'firefighter', who is not in the room, over a loudspeaker, to lie down on the floor next to the window as there is 'a safety issue in the room'.

(a) Explain **two** findings that Adam may discover regarding the participants' reaction to the 'firefighters'.

You should use research evidence about factors affecting obedience to justify your answer.

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2. Question 24 · part a · 4 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

(b) Explain **two** improvements that could be made to Adam's study.

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(Total for Question 24 = 8 marks)

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2. Question 24 · part a · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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3. Question 21 · part a · 2 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

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21 Eniola was in assembly at school. She was talking with her friend and they were playing on their mobile phones whilst the head teacher was speaking.

A new teacher to the school signalled from across the hall to Eniola and her friend to stop talking and playing on their mobile phones. Eniola stopped talking and playing on her mobile phone, but her friend carried on talking and playing on her mobile phone.

(a) Explain how personality could account for Eniola following the teacher's instruction.

(2)

(b) Explain how the situation could account for Eniola's friend not following the teacher's instruction.

(2)

(Total for Question 21 = 4 marks)

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3. Question 21 · part a · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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4. Question 21 · part b · 2 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

21 Eniola was in assembly at school. She was talking with her friend and they were playing on their mobile phones whilst the head teacher was speaking.

A new teacher to the school signalled from across the hall to Eniola and her friend to stop talking and playing on their mobile phones. Eniola stopped talking and playing on her mobile phone, but her friend carried on talking and playing on her mobile phone.

(a) Explain how personality could account for Eniola following the teacher's instruction.

(2)

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(b) Explain how the situation could account for Eniola's friend not following the teacher's instruction.

(2)

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(Total for Question 21 = 4 marks)

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4. Question 21 · part b · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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5. Question 23 · part a · 4 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

23 Hannah was investigating how obedient people would be to an authority figure.

She got permission from a train station to conduct her investigation during a busy rush hour period. Passengers were requested to only leave the train station via one of the exits by an authority figure.

Hannah compared the findings from three variations:

Variation A: the request was given in person or over a loudspeaker.

Variation B: the request was given by a man who wore a uniform or casual clothes.

Variation C: the request was given by a male or female authority figure.

Hannah's results are shown in **Table 5**.

	Variation A: Authority figure presence		Variation B: Clothes worn by authority figure		Variation C: Gender of authority figure	
	In person	Loudspeaker	Uniform	Casual	Male	Female
% obedience	30	10	45	15	30	30

Table 5

(a) Explain **two** conclusions that could be made in terms of obedience to authority using the data in **Table 5**.

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5. Question 23 · part a · 4 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

(b) Explain **one** strength and **one** weakness of Hannah's investigation.

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(Total for Question 23 = 8 marks)

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5. Question 23 · part a · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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6. Question 23 · part whole · 4 marks

2021 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

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23 A high-ranking soldier in the army is ordering the soldiers in his command to harm innocent villagers.

He is telling the soldiers to go to the houses in the village, remove people from their houses and take them to a central unit where they are being hurt.

The people in the houses are all innocent of any crime.

Explain **two** ways that blind obedience to the high-ranking soldier could be prevented.

You should use concepts or research evidence about obedience to authority to justify your answer.

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(Total for Question 23 = 4 marks)

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6. Question 23 · part whole · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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